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What it will take for India to get there by 2047

By RAJ CHENGAPPA

The Metaverse. The idea belonged in science fiction and cyber culture imaginations till Mark Zuckerberg made it the new handle of his colossal digital empire. The nomenclature stood for an expansive network of interconnected digital universes that could, conceivably, virtually enhance physical reality while physically transforming virtual reality. Sounds like gobbledygook? Here's the simple explanation. Right now, despite the fabulous advances in technology, we largely rely on 2D interface communication—the kind you see on Zoom or MS Teams. You have virtual meetings, but not the sense of shared physical space. What happens when you are finally able to make real eye contact and read body language? Why, you could even do a beam-me-up-Scotty kind of thing, and teleport your digital avatar to a factory to inspect it or try out new clothes at a shop. What you will need is 3D communication technology. It is in the making and you will have to wait for it, not till 2047, when India celebrates 100 years of its Independence, but till 2027—just four years from now.

Illustration by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY